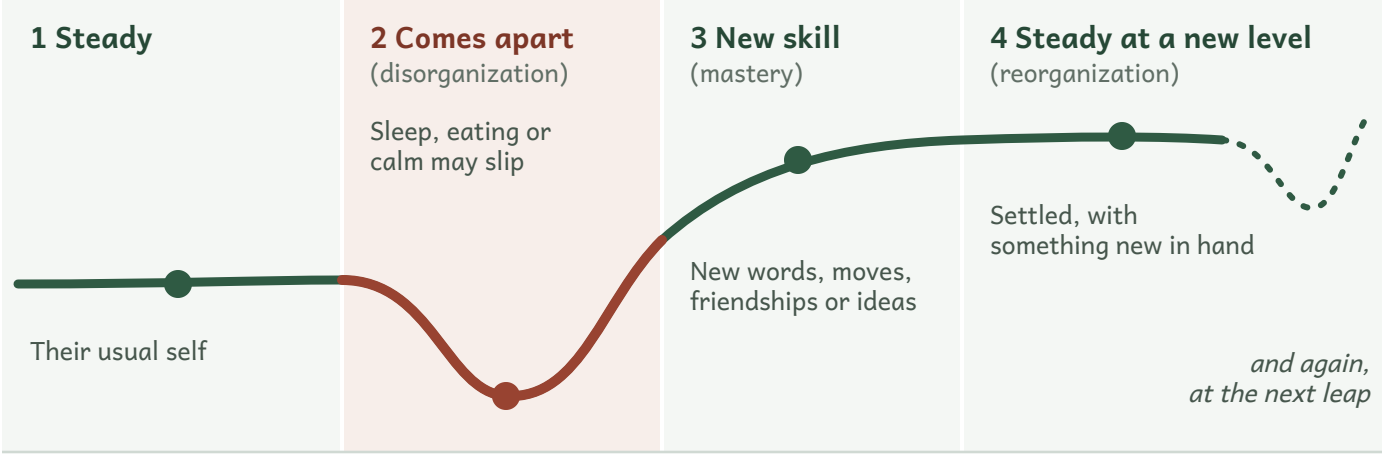
Fulton Community School

Unsettled before a leap

For	Ages	Drawn from
Team inquiries	**Two to five**	**Brazelton's Touchpoints**

Growth comes in spurts. A child often comes apart for a while just before something new.

The path



Why it happens

Energy goes to the new skill
So much effort goes into what is coming next that sleep, eating or calm can slip.

Old ways are reorganizing
What worked before no longer fits, and new ways are still forming.

It passes
Coming apart is usually temporary, and new growth follows.

Leaps we often see from two to five

- Talking in longer sentences
- Making and keeping friends
- Reading others' feelings
- Using the toilet on their own
- Pretend play and storytelling
- New ways of moving
- Big new ideas, and new fears
- Doing more for themselves

Adapted from T. Berry Brazelton and Joshua Sparrow, The Touchpoints Model of Development (2003), Touchpoints Birth to Three and Touchpoints Three to Six.

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You may see

- A skill slips for a while
- Clinging and harder goodbyes
- Feelings come apart faster
- Sleep, eating or toileting changes
- More refusing, more no
- Old comforts stop working

We respond

- **Describe** what we see, and leave out judgments
- **A calm adult to borrow from** (co-regulation)
- **Watch for the new skill** and name it with the child
- **More connection** and a steady, predictable day
- **Keep guiding.** An unsettled time still needs our limits

We ask

- What might this child be about to grow into?
- Is this behavior new, and does it come with other changes?
- What is new lately, in words, movement, play or friendships?
- What do we bring? Our own beliefs and biases shape what we see.

With the family

- The family is the expert on their child
- Mixed feelings are part of parenting
- Every family has strengths and wants to do well by their child
- Share what we each see, and the hopeful part

When to look closer

The changes go on for a long time or keep growing. A skill is lost and nothing new seems to be coming. The team or the family is worried. Talk with the director about next steps together.

Adapted from T. Berry Brazelton and Joshua Sparrow, The Touchpoints Model of Development (2003), Touchpoints Birth to Three and Touchpoints Three to Six.